

be anything between 1.5 and 1.89, from the lightest to the heaviest variety of glass. Look at Figure 3, which shows the Material UI with the glass settings, to get an idea of how glass could be simulated.

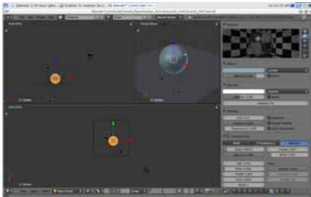


Figure 3: The Material UI of Blender with the glass settings



Figure 4: Settings for simulation of Brass

Creating brass: Creating metallic materials in Blender is not so difficult. The factors to consider are the correct diffuse colour values, reflectivity, glossiness and the shiny look. Figure 4 shows you the correct values adjusted to simulate the look of brass.

Creating wax: Here, it becomes necessary to introduce a new element—sub-surface scattering. The index of refraction should also be set correctly, to give the right look to the material—a soft translucence that wax has. Figure 5 shows the settings to simulate realistic-looking wax.

Simulating iron: Similarly, simulating iron becomes fairly easy once you understand how metallic surfaces reflect light. Figure 6 shows the settings for simulating iron.

Render your materials applied to a simple scene

Create a simple scene with a glass tumbler, an iron basin, a brass pot and a candle. Apply your materials to them, and then make a quick render using the F12 button. Figure 7 displays the rendered scene.

Creating good materials or textures within Blender is an endless process of learning and experimentation to come up with novel permutations and combinations of your own—and in the process, the Blender user community benefits.

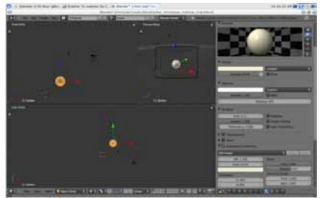


Figure 5: Settings for wax

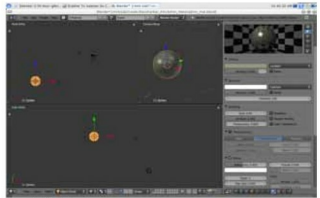


Figure 6: Simulating iron



Figure 7: The rendered scene

My final advice, however, would be to go on observing realistic materials around you in the real world. Try to emulate the look of those materials in your Blender projects. The best way would be to use a professional camera and practice taking high-resolution photographs of materials and textures that you come across in daily life. This would not only give you access to the best materials, it would also train you in creating the best seamless textures for your models. Once you have your high-resolution pictures, it is quite easy to convert it to a seamless texture, either in Photoshop or in the GIMP. **END** 

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The author is good at handling programs like Adobe Photoshop and Blender. He is also skilled at programming and in Linux software.